

8-10 games being auto-installed during set-up despite never explicitly giving permission. Add to that excessive pop-up notifications, folders of “suggested apps” that cannot be removed and more, and you’ve got yourself an unpleasant UI experience. The phone comes with Android 13 with Realme UI 4.0 on top. The company promises 2 years of OS updates and 3 years of security updates as well, which is pretty decent. Software and UI aside, let’s now delve into the hardware of the phone that makes the phone tick.

The Realme 11 Pro is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 7050 SoC which is manufactured on the 6 nm process and comes with a maximum clock speed of 2.6 GHz. At this price range, the processor performs admirably well, beating out a couple of similarly-priced alternatives. I compared the Realme 11 Pro to the OPPO F23 5G, POCO X5 Pro, and last year’s Redmi K50i.

The Realme 11 Pro beat out the OPPO F23 and POCO X5 Pro in both AnTuTu and GeekBench Single Core. However, in the Multi-Core test, the POCO X5 Pro pulls ahead. The Redmi K50i beats the Realme 11 Pro soundly in AnTuTu and GeekBench Multi-Core but lags behind slightly in the Single Core test. One area where the Realme 11 Pro shone was PCMarkWork which emulates day-to-day tasks such as using sheets, photo editing, and more. The Realme 11 Pro beat out all three competitors with ease here.

In GPU tests though, the Realme 11 Pro falls behind with the POCO X5 Pro and Redmi K50i clocking better scores in GFXBench and 3D Mark. Real-world gaming was smooth though. I was getting consistent frame rates at High Graphics with ease and the phone also didn’t heat up much during extended gaming sessions. We tried Asphalt 9 Legends on this phone as well, and the experience was excellent.

Realme has done well controlling the thermals of the phone, so the phone barely throttles even at peak load. In the CPU Throttling Test, the Realme 11 Pro throttled to 92 per cent of its peak performance, which is excellent. Overall, the phone offers smooth and reliable performance in the sub-₹25K price segment; it is nothing

game-changing but it is decent. However, this experience is marred by excessive bloatware and push notifications.

CAMERAS

Realme has packed new cameras in its latest number series. While the Realme 11 Pro+ gets a 200 MP shooter, the 11 Pro houses a 100 MP Omnivision camera alongside a token 2 MP depth lens. The primary camera has Optical Image Stabilisation support as well. Realme also heavily promoted its 2x lossless or “in-sensor zoom” heavily. There’s also an Auto Zoom feature that crops onto a subject and attempts to centre it in the frame.

The selfie camera is a 16 MP Sony IMX471 lens which we’ve seen on some Realme phones before. The 100 MP camera saves 12 MP shots by default and the photos taken in daylight look fantastic, for the most part. The dynamic range is solid, detail retention is good, and colours are vivid - a bit oversaturated, but many may enjoy this look.

The 2x lossless zoom shots are packed with detail but they do look a bit over-sharpened. There’s also an option to click full resolution 100 MP shots that have natural colours but slightly inadequate dynamic range.

Portrait images that are assisted by the 2 MP depth lens look good with decent edge detection, however, skin tones aren’t the most accurate. Selfie photos from the 16 MP shooter look slightly soft and struggle with dynamic range in tricky lighting.

Low light shots from the 100 MP camera are quite impressive; colours look good, dynamic range is decent and the detail is also adequate. There is some noise but I’ve seen worse at this price. Turning on Nightscape alleviates some noise issues, but the photos can look slightly unnatural.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme 11 Pro features a 5,000 mAh battery, the same as its predecessor. The phone comes equipped with 67 W fast charging, a marked improvement over the 10 Pro. There’s no wireless charging, but that’s a rarity in the

mid-range smartphone segment. The phone’s battery life is impressive and long-lasting; the device lasted 14 hours and 15 minutes in our 4K video loop test on a full charge. I played Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes, and the phone’s battery level only dropped by 4 per cent (from 88% to 84%) and GPS Navigation for an hour on Google Maps dropped it by 5 per cent (83 % to 78%). A full charge using the bundled 67 W charger took 46 minutes, and charging the phone up to 50 per cent merely took 18 minutes.

VERDICT

Realme has delivered a truly elevated experience with the Realme 11 Pro in terms of design language, camera quality, display, and even battery life. When compared to the Realme 10 Pro, the improvements are tangible. Of course, that being said, the Realme 11 Pro+ is quite close in price but offers some serious upgrades compared to the 11 Pro, so the company could be competing with itself in that regard. Nevertheless, in the sub-₹25K price segment, this is the best-looking phone, in my opinion, that also offers reliable performance in most other avenues. Low-light photography could be slightly improved and an IP rating would be an added assurance. But we are nitpicking, and these misses wouldn’t necessarily affect too many people’s buying decisions. For the price, the Realme 11 Pro is an easy recommendation; a well-rounded phone. However, if you are an ardent mobile gamer who only cares about performance, the Redmi K50i and the more expensive iQOO Neo 7 are better options.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7050 | RAM: Up to 12 GB LPDDR4X | Internal storage: Up to 256 GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging wattage: 67 W | Cameras (rear): 100 MP (OIS) + 2 MP Portrait | Selfie camera: 16 MP | Video: At up to 4K at 30 fps (rear) | Weight: 191 g | Thickness: 8.7 mm | Software: Realme UI 4.0, Android 13

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